

Rasoul Foroughfard

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Education

Arizona State University

Ph.D. in Finance Tempe, AZ 2027 (Expected)

Dissertation Committee: Oliver Boguth, Hendrik Bessembinder, George Aragon, Mazi Kazemi

Sharif University of Technology

M.S. in Economics Tehran, Iran 2017

Persian Gulf University

B.S. in Economics Bushehr, Iran 2014

Research Interests

Empirical Asset Pricing, Investments, Investor Demand, Behavioral Finance, Business Cycles

Working Papers

- **Household Demand Pressure and Equity Mispricing** [\[PDF\]](#)

Job Market Paper.

- ▷ **Abstract:** Household demand shocks generate valuation distortions when the institutional investors absorbing them are insufficiently elastic. I develop a measure of household demand pressure, defined as household latent demand scaled by institutional absorption capacity, and show that it explains both contemporaneous price impacts and long-horizon return reversals. Stocks experiencing greater household demand pressure earn significantly lower subsequent returns for up to five years, with the strongest effects occurring when institutional absorption capacity is limited.

- **Net Buyback Dynamics and Risk** [\[PDF\]](#)

Revise and Resubmit, Journal of Portfolio Management.

- ▷ **Abstract:** This paper studies the premium associated with firms' cash-flow cyclicity, as reflected in their payout composition. The net buyback-to-dividend ratio classifies firms by cash-flow cyclicity because the permanent component of earnings is typically distributed as dividends, while the temporary component is distributed through buybacks. The ratio therefore captures firms' cash-flow sensitivity to business cycles. I find that this measure proxies for cash-flow procyclicality and that investors require a positive premium for holding buyback-dominated assets.

- **Who Responds to Changes in the Market Risk Premia, and How?** [\[PDF\]](#)

- ▷ **Abstract:** Variation in market risk premia is reflected in the portfolio decisions of only a limited and identifiable subset of institutional investors. Using quarterly 13F holdings, I show that approximately 60% of institutions do not systematically adjust aggregate equity exposure as compensation for bearing market risk changes over time. Among those that do respond, exposure adjustments are highly heterogeneous in both sign and magnitude.

- **Industry Level Signals from Institutional Portfolio Reallocations** [\[PDF\]](#)

- ▷ **Abstract:** This paper develops a framework to extract and quantify the information embedded in institutional investors' industry-level demand. Changes in portfolio allocations across industries are interpreted as signals about future returns, and investors are identified as industry experts based on the historical accuracy of their allocation shifts in predicting subsequent industry performance. Aggregating these expert signals yields a novel

measure, Revealed Industry Information (RII), which strongly predicts future industry returns. A long-short portfolio formed on RII earns a six-factor alpha of 1.6% per quarter after controlling for the Fama-French five factors and momentum.

- **Granular Industry Fundamentals and Equity Forecasting** [\[PDF\]](#)

Co-authored with Elham Ghorbani.

- ▷ **Abstract:** This paper examines whether real economic information from U.S. industries predicts subsequent equity returns. Using monthly measures of production, employment, hours worked, sales, and inventories across a broad panel of industries, we show that industry-level fundamentals predict both aggregate market returns and industry-level equity returns out of sample. The predictive content is strongest in upstream sectors such as manufacturing, transportation, and mining.

Teaching Experience

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- **Security Analysis and Portfolio Management (FIN 421)** Fall 2024
Arizona State University, Undergraduate
 - **Advanced Managerial Finance (FIN 361)** Summer 2026
Arizona State University, Undergraduate

Mean Student Evaluation: 6.7/7.0

Awards

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- **National Economics Olympiad** 2017
Ranked 3rd among approximately 10,000 students
 - **National M.S. Economics Entrance Exam** 2017
Ranked 8th among approximately 10,000 students

Academic Presentations

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- **Financial Management Association** (*Discussant*) 2025
 - **Arizona State University Finance Brownbag** (*Presenter*) 2025

Skills

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- **Software:** Python, R, Stata, MATLAB, SAS, Excel, L^AT_EX
 - **Techniques:** Machine Learning (ML), Large Language Models (LLMs), State Space Models,
 - **Data:** CRSP, Compustat, 13F, FRED, National Income and Input-Output, Bloomberg, I/B/E/S

References

Oliver Boguth	Associate Professor of Finance, ASU	oliver.boguth@asu.edu
Hendrik Bessembinder	Professor of Finance, ASU	hendrik.bessembinder@asu.edu
George Aragon	Professor of Finance, ASU	george.aragon@asu.edu
Maziar Kazemi	Assistant Professor of Finance, ASU	mazi.kazemi@asu.edu